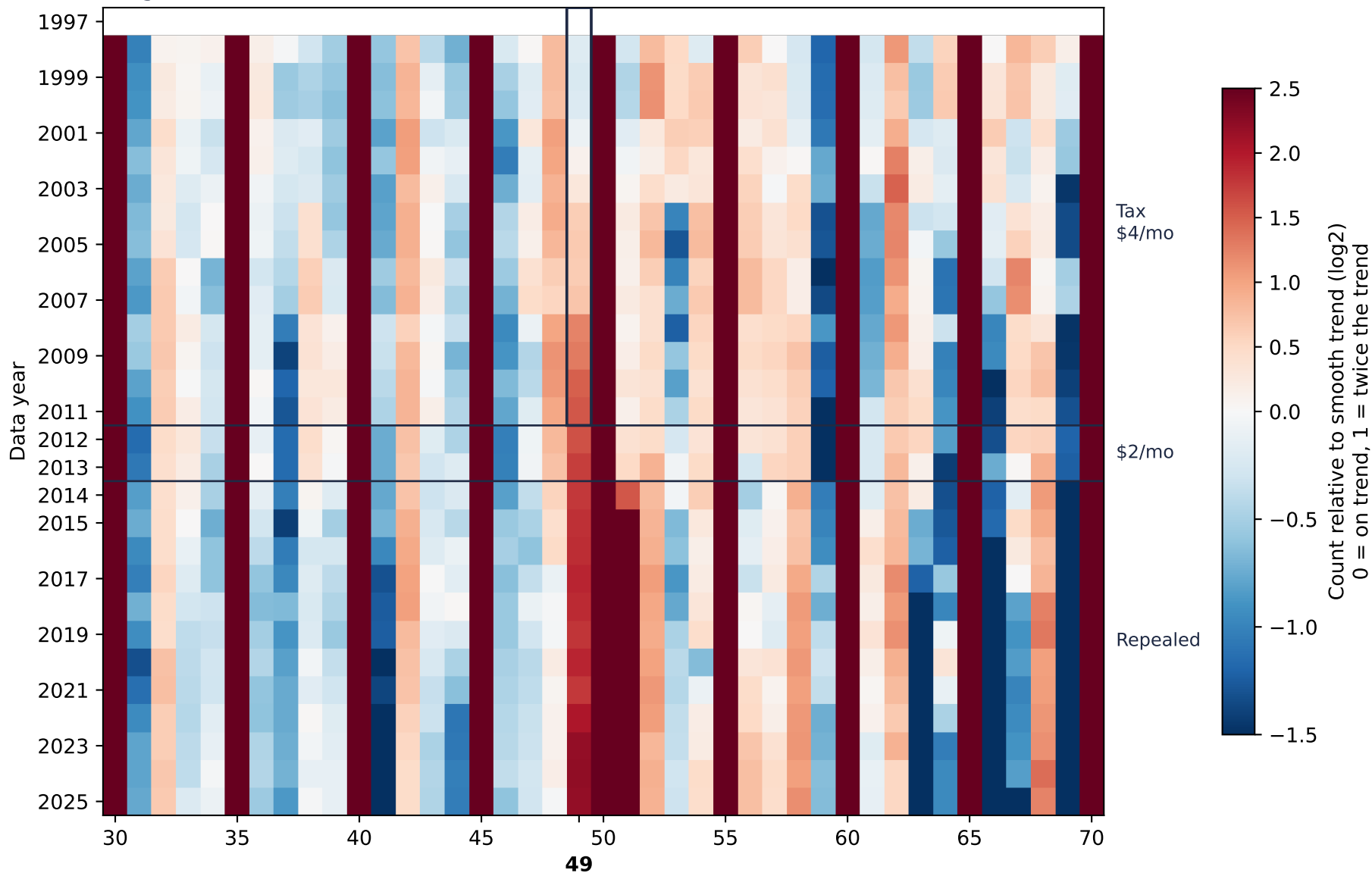


Chicago businesses by employment size, 1997-2025

Single-location businesses with verified headcounts



Red columns at 30, 35, 40, 45, 50 ... are round-number reporting, present with or without the tax. The outlined column is 49, the last untaxed size: avoidance would show as red inside the box and not below it. Trend: quadratic in log counts, fitted each year to sizes not divisible by 5. Source: Data Axle (Infogroup) historical business files.